Microsoft IQ: why context wins the AI deal

Knowit, Nordics · 28 October 2026

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Another week. Another model.

What changed for your customer?



In four years, AI went from talking to doing

Nov 2022	**Chat**	One RFP question. One paragraph.
Late 2024	**Reasoning**	Analyze requirements. Develop a response strategy.
Late 2025	**Agents**	Research, draft, validate, and assemble the proposal.
2026+	**Agentic enterprise**	Orchestrate the entire RFP process across people, agents, and enterprise systems.

Chat answers. An agent plans, acts and checks.



Same model. Different system around it.

78%

Claude Code harness

42%

CORE-Agent harness

Claude Opus 4.5 · CORE-Bench

Ben Gibbs' keynote · Different harnesses, not a Microsoft IQ test. The gap is not context alone.

Your role changes as AI does more of the work

You write it	AI suggests a sentence.
You fix it	AI drafts. You edit.
You brief it	A bounded pre-study, ready for review.
You run it	Parallel work. You set the rules.

Why business work gets stuck at step two

Software

Much of the context is structured

Many outputs can be tested

Consulting work

Context is spread across systems and people

Business definitions can differ

Capable models still need relevant context.

Capable models are widely available.

What does this customer know that the model doesn't?



An agent walks in on day one

A new colleague gets

Laptop and access

Who's who

The project history

A buddy

An agent also needs

Relevant context

Clear access and task boundaries

In the chat: your role, and one thing you wish you'd known on day one.

Microsoft IQ

WHAT KNOWIT CAN DELIVER

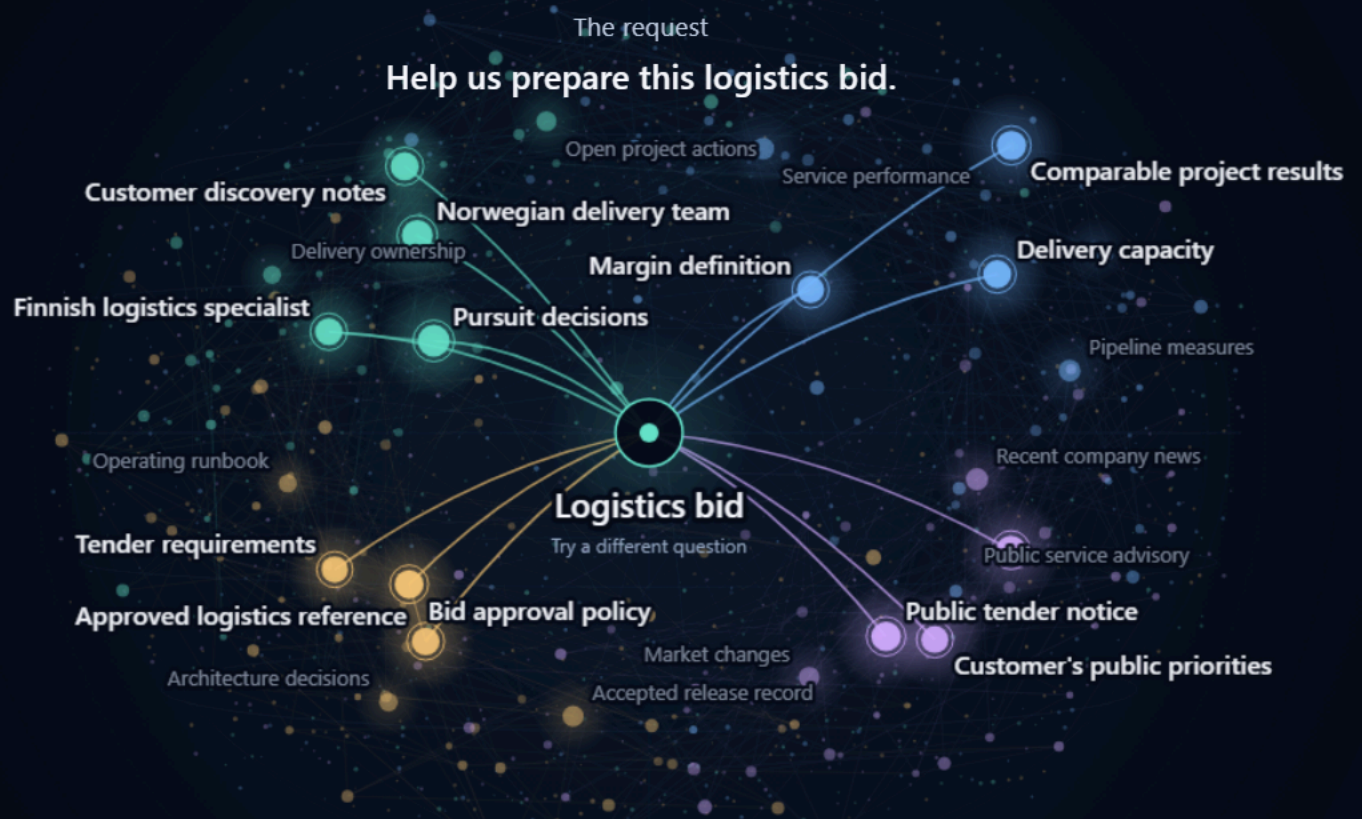
Where else could Knowit use this?

A handover needs different information from a bid. Reuse the sources that fit, with the right access.

- RFP responses
- Meeting preparation
- Finding expertise
- Project handovers
- Service cases
- Leadership decisions

A paid customer engagement

Connect the sources and agree the business definitions. Build the workflow and keep it working.



Change the question. A different set of information matters.

Sources and business definitions can be reused where they fit the next task.

Work IQ	Fabric IQ	Foundry IQ	Web IQ
People & work	Business data & definitions	Trusted knowledge	Public web

Fictional Knowit example. Illustrative relationships and prepared outputs. Configured sources keep their own access controls. No live data is queried.

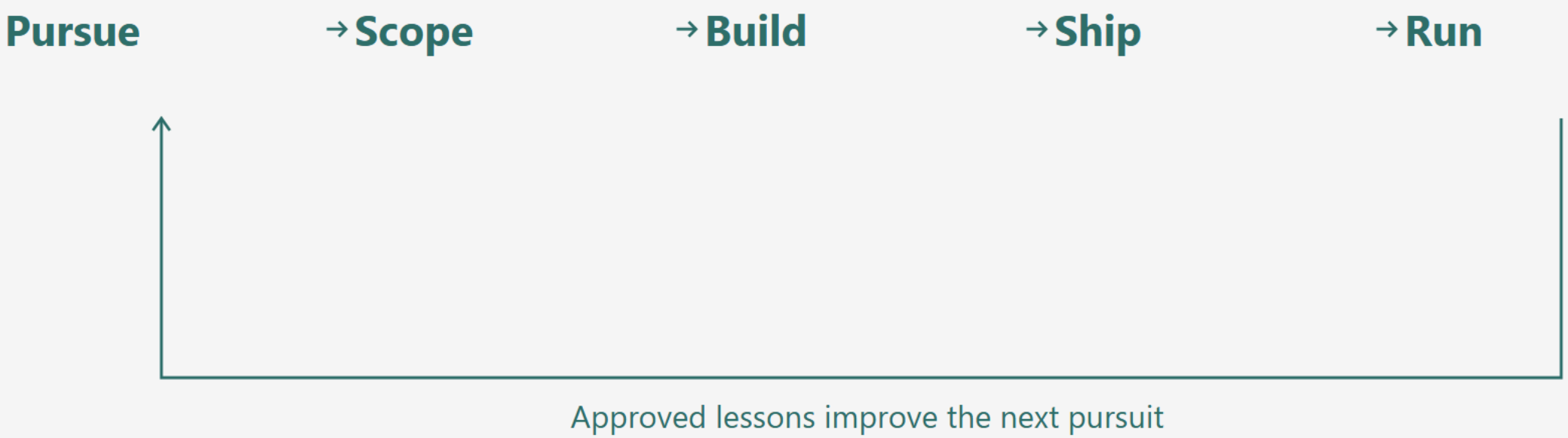
Check what's available before you promise it

Scope	The exact capability and experience
Availability	GA, preview or restricted access
Commercial terms	Licensing, usage and source connections

Verify the exact capability and terms before a customer proposal.

Knowit as customer zero

Try one repeated task. Measure useful work.



Proposed learning motion. No Knowit deployment or pilot is claimed.

One Knowit: combine what we already know

A fictional logistics pursuit

Sweden

A logistics lead

Norway

Approved delivery experience

Finland

Relevant expertise

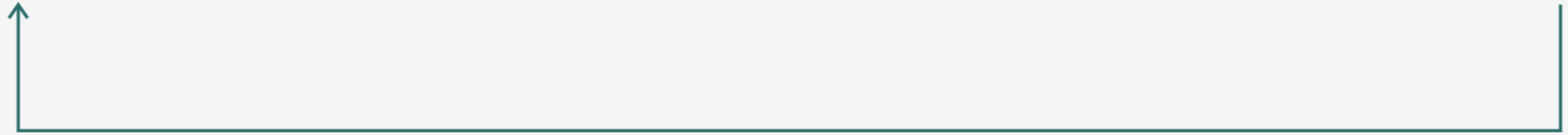
Data · Workplace · Applications

One brief, with an owner

Fictional pursuit. Sources and connections are illustrative.

Keep the context when the team changes

Pursue	→ Scope	→ Build	→ Ship	→ Run
Approved evidence and promises	Agreed outcomes and boundaries	Decisions and checks	Accepted release and ownership	Actual results improve the next pursuit



Approved lessons improve the next pursuit

Same fictional engagement. An owner at each stage.

Watch what the context does

Evidence	What context supports the answer?
Decisions	Where does a person approve?
Economics	What does it cost to run?

Over to Ben Gibbs.



RFP agent for sales

Ben Gibbs

Ben’s live RFP section

Preparing a bid response

Chief-of-Staff agent for sales

Ben Gibbs

Ben’s live Chief-of-Staff section

Shared context for sales leadership

What does it cost to run? How do you bring it down?

Ben Gibbs

Ben’s live AI FinOps section

Customer agent-running costs and evaluations

What can Knowit sell?

Context foundation	Source map + definitions. Measure answer agreement.
Process to production	Approved workflow. Measure effort and response quality.
Evaluate and optimise	Evaluation service. Measure cost per accepted outcome.

Proposed paid deliverables. Agree the baseline and quality threshold.

Why build on Microsoft?

Start with the context this customer already has.

Reuse

Microsoft 365 work context

Business meaning

Useful Fabric or Power BI models

Controls

Configured access and identity

Reuse depends on supported connections, licences and configured access.

Objections you will hear

'We run Snowflake.'	Validate coexistence.
'We have Salesforce.'	Keep the workflow in view.
'Glean already does this.'	Compare on the same task.
'Is it ready?'	Start with what's GA.
'What will it cost?'	One process, cost per outcome.

Take the exact workflow and access requirements into the comparison.

Which customer or project does this fit?

In the chat: customer or project + why

After today	The plays and one-pager, with one clear ask
Then	Choose one next step together

A safe description or private message is fine. No confidential detail.

Capable models are widely available.

What does this customer know that the model doesn't?

Questions · Customer or project + why. Chat or private message.